

High-Protein Green Goddess Salad Is Ready in 15 Minutes

This green goddess salad is crisp, creamy and packed with fresh herbs. A vibrant basil-yogurt dressing coats crunchy cabbage, romaine and cucumber, while avocado adds richness for a refreshing side that pairs well with grilled meats or seafood.

By **Megan Ginsberg** | Published on April 8, 2026

✓ Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 15 mins

Total Time: 15 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

No Added Sugar Gut Healthy Anti-Inflammatory Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free Low-Carb Nut-Free
Healthy Pregnancy Healthy Immunity Soy-Free High-Fiber High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free

Ingredients

Dressing

- 1 cup loosely packed fresh basil leaves
- $\frac{3}{4}$ cup whole-milk plain strained yogurt, such as Greek-style
- $\frac{1}{4}$ cup chopped fresh chives
- 2 tablespoons lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 tablespoon fresh tarragon leaves
- 1 teaspoon anchovy paste
- $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon plus $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon salt
- 1 medium clove garlic, chopped

Salad

- 3 cups thinly sliced green cabbage
- 3 cups thinly sliced baby romaine lettuce
- $\frac{1}{2}$ cups chopped seeded English cucumber
- 3 tablespoons chopped scallions
- 1 medium avocado, diced

Directions

Step 1

To prepare dressing: Combine 1 cup basil, $\frac{3}{4}$ cup yogurt, $\frac{1}{4}$ cup chives, 2 tablespoons lemon juice, 2 tablespoons oil, 1 tablespoon tarragon, 1 teaspoon anchovy paste, $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon plus $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon salt and the chopped garlic in a mini food processor. Process until smooth and bright green, about 1 minute, scraping down the sides as needed.

Step 2

To prepare salad: Toss 3 cups cabbage, 3 cups romaine, $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups cucumber and 3 tablespoons scallions in a large bowl. Gently fold in diced avocado.

Step 3

Drizzle the dressing over the salad; toss until evenly coated.

To make ahead

Refrigerate dressing in an airtight container for up to 3 days.

Frequently Asked Questions

How did the salad get its name?



The Green Goddess salad is said to have been created by a chef at the Palace Hotel in San Francisco to honor actor George Arliss, a hotel guest who was starring in the 1920s stage play "Green Goddess."

Can I swap the cabbage for another green?



Absolutely! You can use shredded kale or any other sturdy green as a substitute for the cabbage.

Do I need to peel the cucumber?



We recommend using an English cucumber, as it has thin skin that doesn't need to be peeled and contains very small, tender seeds. This makes it more pleasant to eat and prevents excess moisture from entering your salad.

How should I store leftovers?



Once dressed, the salad is best enjoyed immediately and doesn't store well. If you anticipate leftovers, it's best to refrigerate the salad and dressing in separate airtight containers to keep the salad ingredients crisp.

What should I serve with Green Goddess Salad?



This salad can easily be turned into a main meal by topping it with a protein or serving it alongside a main course like Sheet-Pan Lemon-Pepper Chicken, High-Protein Air-Fryer Burgers, Blackened Salmon, baked ham or Sweet & Spicy Soy-Braised Short Ribs. Additionally, it would be excellent served alongside Crispy Oven-Roasted Potatoes, grilled bread or a simple soup for a balanced menu.

Recipe developed by Marianne Williams

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 1¾ cups** 209 calories; total fat 16g; saturated fat 3g; cholesterol 6mg; sodium 314mg; total carbohydrate 13g; dietary fiber 6g; total sugars 5g; added sugars 0g; protein 7g; vitamin c 35mg; calcium 115mg; iron 2mg; potassium 581mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

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